

Day 87 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (6): The Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2026

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2026 — a major decriminalisation reform passed by Parliament in 2026.

Q: When was the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2026 introduced, and what is its current status?

A: Introduced in the Lok Sabha on 27 March 2026; it has since been PASSED by both Houses of Parliament.

Q: What is the Bill's core purpose?

A: To decriminalise or rationalise offences and penalties across central Acts — promoting 'ease of doing business' and 'ease of living' by removing/softening minor criminal penalties for technical or procedural lapses.

Q: How many Central Acts and Ministries does the Bill cover, and how many total provisions does it amend?

A: 79 Central Acts, administered by 23 Ministries, covering 784 total provisions.

Q: How are the 784 provisions split between decriminalisation and ease-of-living amendments?

A: 717 provisions are decriminalised (Ease of Doing Business); 67 provisions are amended for Ease of Living.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2026 was introduced in the Lok Sabha on:

- A. 27 January 2026
- B. 27 February 2026
- C. 27 March 2026 ✓**
- D. 27 April 2026

Explanation: 27 March 2026. [hard, web-research]

2. The Jan Vishwas Bill, 2026's core purpose is to:

- A. Increase criminal penalties across all laws
- B. Decriminalise/rationalise offences and penalties across central Acts ✓**
- C. Create new regulatory bodies
- D. Amend the Constitution's federal structure

Explanation: Decriminalise/rationalise offences and penalties. [medium, web-research]

3. The Jan Vishwas Bill, 2026 amends how many Central Acts?

- A. 49
- B. 59
- C. 69
- D. 79 ✓**

Explanation: 79 Central Acts. [hard, web-research]

4. Of the Bill's 784 total provisions, how many are decriminalised for Ease of Doing Business?

- A. 617
- B. 667
- C. 717 ✓**
- D. 767

Explanation: 717 provisions. [hard, web-research]

5. Unlike the Day-75-covered 131st Constitutional Amendment Bill (which was rejected), the Jan Vishwas Bill, 2026 was:

- A. Also rejected
- B. Withdrawn before voting
- C. Passed by both Houses of Parliament ✓**
- D. Referred indefinitely to a Select Committee

Explanation: Passed by both Houses of Parliament. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Compound Interest

READING MATERIAL

Compound Interest is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows TNPSC tests the standard CI formula, a useful SI-vs-CI shortcut, AND disguises CI as 'successive percentage change' word problems (depreciation, year-over-year growth) — recognize all three shapes.

Q: Formula: What is the Compound Interest formula, and the shortcut for the DIFFERENCE between SI and CI over 2 years?

A: Amount = $P(1+R/100)^T$, so CI = Amount – P. For exactly 2 years, there's a shortcut: $CI - SI = P \times (R/100)^2$. This avoids computing CI and SI separately when you only need their difference.

Q: Real exam (2022): Find the difference between SI and CI for 2 years on a principal of Rs.5,000 at 8% per annum.

A: Using the shortcut: difference = $P \times (R/100)^2 = 5000 \times (0.08)^2 = 5000 \times 0.0064 = \text{Rs.}32$. (Full check: SI = $5000 \times 8 \times 2/100 = 800$. CI = $5000 \times (1.08^2 - 1) = 5000 \times 0.1664 = 832$. Difference = $832 - 800 = 32$ ✓.)

Q: Real exam (2022): Find the compound interest on Rs.5,000 at 12% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

A: CI = $P \times ((1+R/100)^T - 1) = 5000 \times (1.12^2 - 1) = 5000 \times (1.2544 - 1) = 5000 \times 0.2544 = \text{Rs.}1,272$.

Q: Real exam (2025): A sum becomes Rs.13,380 after 3 years and Rs.20,070 after 6 years on compound interest. Find the original sum.

A: The amount after 6 years equals the amount after 3 years multiplied by the SAME growth factor again (since compounding is multiplicative): $(1+R/100)^3 = 20070/13380 = 1.5$. The sum itself: $P = \text{Amount-after-3-years} \div (1+R/100)^3 = 13380 \div 1.5 = \text{Rs.}8,920$.

Q: Real exam (2024): A motorcycle's value 2 years ago was Rs.80,000. It depreciates 4% in the first year, then increases 4% in the second year. Find the present value.

A: Apply each year's change as its own multiplier, in sequence — this is compound interest with a changing/mixed rate: $80,000 \times 0.96$ (first year, -4%) $\times 1.04$ (second year, +4%) = $80,000 \times 0.9984 = \text{Rs.}79,872$. Note the result is slightly LESS than the original Rs.80,000 — a decrease followed by an equal-percentage increase never fully cancels out, since the increase applies to a smaller base.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the difference between SI and CI for 2 years on a principal of Rs.8,000 at 5% per annum.

- A. Rs.18
- B. Rs.20 ✓**
- C. Rs.22
- D. Rs.25

Explanation: Difference = $P \times (R/100)^2 = 8000 \times (0.05)^2 = 8000 \times 0.0025 = \text{Rs.}20$. [medium, authored]

2. Find the compound interest on Rs.10,000 at 10% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

- A. Rs.2,000
- B. Rs.2,100 ✓**
- C. Rs.2,200
- D. Rs.1,900

Explanation: CI = $10000 \times (1.10^2 - 1) = 10000 \times 0.21 = \text{Rs.}2,100$. [easy, authored]

3. A sum becomes Rs.16,000 after 2 years and Rs.19,360 after 4 years on compound interest. Find the original sum.

- A. Rs.12,500
- B. Rs.13,000
- C. Rs.13,223 ✓**
- D. Rs.14,000

Explanation: $(1+R/100)^2 = 19360/16000 = 1.21$. $P = 16000/1.21 \approx \text{Rs.}13,223$. [hard, authored]

4. A machine valued at Rs.50,000 depreciates by 10% in the first year and a further 10% in the second year. Find its value after 2 years.

- A. Rs.40,000
- B. Rs.40,500 ✓**
- C. Rs.41,000
- D. Rs.39,500

Explanation: $50,000 \times 0.90 \times 0.90 = 50,000 \times 0.81 = \text{Rs.}40,500$. [medium, authored]

5. Find the compound interest on Rs.20,000 at 15% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

A. Rs.6,000

B. Rs.6,450 ✓

C. Rs.6,200

D. Rs.6,500

Explanation: $CI = 20000 \times (1.15^2 - 1) = 20000 \times 0.3225 = \text{Rs.}6,450$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "A Tragic Story" — William Makepeace Thackeray

READING MATERIAL

A short comic poem about a sage obsessed with moving his pigtail from behind him to in front, who never succeeds. Real coaching-site evidence shows this poem is tested almost entirely as 'identify the figure of speech in this line' — and the pattern is consistent enough to learn as a rule rather than memorizing 12 separate answers.

Q: What is the plot of "A Tragic Story"?

A: A sage ('in days of yore') is bothered that his pigtail (braid) hangs behind him. He spins around — round and round, all day — trying to bring it to the front. No matter how he turns, the pigtail stays faithfully behind him, since it's physically attached to his back and turns with him. He never succeeds.

Q: What is the poem's central theme/lesson?

A: The futility of attempting an impossible task, told humorously — the sage's persistent, theoretical effort is undercut by his lack of practical understanding (the pigtail can never NOT be behind him while attached to his back, no matter which way he spins).

Q: What is the recurring figure of speech used whenever the poem mentions the pigtail still hanging behind him, despite all his efforts?

A: Irony — there's a gap between his persistent, hopeful effort and the physically inevitable outcome (it was always going to stay behind him). Lines like 'But still it hung behind him' and 'Because it hung behind him' are both cited examples.

Q: What figure of speech describes the poem's repeated phrases like 'round and round' and 'right and left and round about'?

A: Repetition — the same words/phrase repeated for emphasis, here mimicking the sage's repetitive, futile spinning motion.

Q: What figure of speech is used in lines like 'There lived a sage in days of yore', 'All day the puzzled sage did spin', and 'He mused upon this curious case'?

A: Alliteration — repeated initial consonant sounds within the line (sage/spin/days; mused/this — note: alliteration specifically repeats STARTING sounds of nearby words, distinguishing it from the whole-phrase Repetition examples above).

Q: Who wrote "A Tragic Story", and is it meant to be read seriously?

A: William Makepeace Thackeray. Despite the title, it's a humorous/comic poem, not an actual tragedy — the 'tragic' framing is itself part of the joke, given how trivial the sage's problem really is.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. What was the sage in "A Tragic Story" trying to do?

- A. Grow a longer pigtail
- B. Move his pigtail to the front ✓**
- C. Cut off his pigtail
- D. Dye his pigtail

Explanation: He spent all day spinning, trying to bring his pigtail around to the front. [easy, web-research]

2. Was the sage ever successful in moving his pigtail?

- A. Yes, after many tries
- B. Yes, immediately
- C. No, it always stayed behind him ✓**
- D. The poem doesn't say

Explanation: No matter how he spun, the pigtail — attached to his back — always remained behind him. [easy, web-research]

3. Identify the figure of speech: "But still it hung behind him."

- A. Simile
- B. Personification
- C. Irony ✓**
- D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Irony — his effort can never change a physically inevitable outcome. [medium, web-research]

4. Identify the figure of speech: the repeated use of "round and round" in the poem.

- A. Hyperbole
- B. Onomatopoeia

C. Anaphora

D. Repetition ✓

Explanation: Repetition — the same phrase repeated to emphasize his repetitive spinning. [medium, web-research]

5. Identify the figure of speech: "All day the puzzled sage did spin."

A. Hyperbole

B. Alliteration ✓

C. Assonance

D. Personification

Explanation: Alliteration — repeated initial sounds (e.g. 'sage'/'spin'). [medium, web-research]

6. What is the overall dominant figure of speech across "A Tragic Story"?

A. Hyperbole

B. Irony ✓

C. Alliteration

D. Personification

Explanation: Irony — the entire poem's comic premise rests on the gap between effort and an unchangeable outcome. [medium, web-research]

7. "A Tragic Story" was written by:

A. Lewis Carroll

B. Robert Louis Stevenson

C. William Makepeace Thackeray ✓

D. Edgar Albert Guest

Explanation: William Makepeace Thackeray. [easy, web-research]

8. Despite its title, "A Tragic Story" is best described as:

A. A genuine tragedy

B. A humorous poem ✓

C. A horror poem

D. A romantic poem

Explanation: It's comic, not tragic — the title itself is part of the joke given how trivial the sage's 'problem' is. [easy, web-research]